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THE BYLINE METHOD

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THE VOICE CAPTURE AND GHOSTWRITING FRAMEWORK — DOCUMENTED FOR THE FIRST TIME.

By MK Parrish

Price: \$38

Why this exists

Ghostwriting that works doesn't sound ghostwritten. It sounds like the person — on their best day, with an editor in their head. Most ghostwriting fails at exactly this point. It's competent and generic. It could be anyone. And the moment a reader thinks "this doesn't sound like them," the trust is gone.

The whole craft hinges on one thing nobody documents: how you *capture a voice* and then *write inside it* so faithfully that the person reads their own piece and says "that's exactly what I would have said — I just couldn't get it out."

The Byline is my done-for-you ghostwriting service. This is the method underneath it, written down for the first time. Use it to ghostwrite for someone else — a founder, an exec, a client. Or use it on *yourself*: to capture your own voice on a good day and write in it even when you're tired, rushed, or staring at a blank page.

The method runs in four parts: capture the voice, calibrate it across formats, write inside it, and keep the engine running with an editorial calendar. Start with capture — everything downstream depends on a voice you've actually pinned down.

Part 1 — The Voice-Capture Interview

Voice doesn't live in a style guide. It lives in how a person actually talks when they forget they're being recorded. The interview's whole job is to get them talking like that, then mine the recording for the patterns.

Record it. Always. You're not listening for content — you're listening for *how they say things*. The transcript is the raw material.

THE INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Ask these in order. Let them ramble. The gold is usually in the tangent, not the answer.

Part 2 — The Tone Calibration Guide (across formats)

Voice is constant. *Tone* shifts by format. The same person writes a LinkedIn post and a keynote and a client email differently — but it's still recognizably them. The skill is dialing tone up or down without losing the voice.

THE CALIBRATION TABLE

FORMAT	TONE DIAL	LENGTH	OPENING MOVE	WHAT STAYS CONSTANT
LinkedIn post	punchy, opinionated	short	hook line, stands alone	the POV, go-to phrases
Newsletter	warm, generous	medium	"you" focused, a story	cadence, humor
Keynote / talk	bold, performative	spoken	a question or a claim	the hill they die on
Client email	direct, warm	tight	the ask up front	contractions, plainness
Long essay	reflective, layered	long	a tension or a confession	the POV, the reader
Bio / profile	confident, compressed	very short	the one known-for thing	no humblebrag

THE RULE

Whatever the format, three things never move: **the point of view, the go-to cadence, and the hard no's**. Tone can flex loud or quiet. Those three are load-bearing — drop them and the voice breaks.

it badly in public first. So let's talk about how to ship ugly.

Same person every time. The "Look," the poker-flat cadence, the "that's the whole game" — all constant. Only the tone dial moved.

Part 3 — The Writing-in-Voice Framework

Now you write. With the voice profile beside you, a draft becomes a controlled act, not a guess. Run this loop for any piece.

GENERIC DRAFT (correct, but anyone could've written it):

"It's important to take action even when you don't feel fully prepared. Progress comes from doing, not waiting. Many successful people started before they were ready."

IN-VOICE REWRITE (profile applied):

"Look — you're not going to feel ready. I waited two years for that feeling and it never showed. You learn this by doing it badly first. Ship the ugly version. That's the whole game."

The first is a fortune cookie. The second is a specific human with a poker habit and a chip on their shoulder. Same advice. Only one has a pulse.

Part 4 — The Editorial Calendar

A voice is only worth capturing if you use it on a schedule. Sporadic genius loses to consistent presence. Here are the templates to keep the engine running.

The Byline method — one-page recap

1. CAPTURE — interview, record, extract the voice profile
2. CALIBRATE — flex tone by format, keep POV + cadence + no's fixed
3. WRITE — POV angle → their opener → cadence → phrases → no-pass → mo
4. SUSTAIN — pillars + weekly calendar + idea bank from the transcript

When you want it done for you

This is the method. Run it and you can write in a voice — yours or someone else's — that actually sounds like the person.

But capturing a voice and writing inside it for months is a craft *and* a time sink. The interview is the easy part. The hard part is the discipline: staying in voice across fifty pieces, never letting one "synergy" slip through, keeping the calendar full when the person is busy running their actual business. That's a job.

That's **The Byline** — the done-for-you version. I run the capture interview, build the voice profile, and ghostwrite on a calendar so the person shows up consistently, sounding exactly like themselves, without writing a word.

Find it at mkparrish.com.

